

Chapter 66-4

After a long while, Xu Qingzhu suddenly lifted her head from the book and turned to ask Liang Shi: "By the way, today Ling Dang said that a classmate's mother in Rainbow's class looks very similar to me."

Liang Shi's wandering thoughts were pulled back. "Hm?"

"Did you see her?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi nodded: "Yes, very similar."

Xu Qingzhu's fingers brushed across the pages of the book, and she said gently: "Ling Dang also said that little classmate is called Sheng Yu."

Liang Shi paused.

"Mm." Liang Shi tentatively continued following her words: "She also has another name, Su Yu."

"A little kid with two names." Xu Qingzhu curved her lips in a light smile, but there was no warmth in her eyes. Not knowing what she was pondering, her voice also seemed cold. "Not very common."

"Her mother said one was given by her father and one by her mother." Liang Shi watched Xu Qingzhu's expression carefully, speaking leisurely: "But the one being used now is the name her mother gave. And then..."

She paused. "Her mother is called Su Mu. You two have very similar noses and mouths. She's been wearing sunglasses the whole time, so I couldn't see how similar the eyes are."

Xu Qingzhu's hand gripping the page suddenly tightened, and the sound of the paper crinkling was exceptionally crisp.

"Surname Su..." Xu Qingzhu murmured, then smiled: "My uncle's former girlfriend seemed to have the surname Su."

"Hm?" Liang Shi played dumb. "Really? That's quite a coincidence. I remember your mother's surname is Sheng."

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Yes, but there are so many people with the surname Sheng in this world, and my uncle has been dead for many years."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together: "Alright."

After that, neither of them spoke.

Before sleeping, Xu Qingzhu suddenly said: "Liang Shi, this Sunday my mom wants us to come home for dinner. Are you free?"

Liang Shi immediately responded: "Yes, I am."

"Also." Xu Qingzhu said: "This Sunday is my uncle's death anniversary. My mom wants..."

Before Xu Qingzhu could finish, Liang Shi agreed in one breath: "Of course, I'll accompany you all then."

"Okay, thank you." Xu Qingzhu let out a soft breath.

"There's no need for such small matters." Liang Shi said: "Teacher Xu, don't you also have to come back to the old residence with me tomorrow? We're helping each other out."

Xu Qingzhu: "...Alright then."

//

Deep autumn brought frequent rain, and that night the rain started falling pitter-patter again.

Around two o'clock, the rain became heavy, accompanied by a few thunderclaps.

It frightened Ling Dang into whimpering a few times.

Liang Shi patted her back in her sleep, coaxing her to sleep.

But when she half-opened her eyes to look at the other side of the bed, Xu Qingzhu's phone was still lit, viewing something.

However, the rain didn't last long. By dawn it had cleared up.

When Liang Shi woke up, Ling Dang was staring at her with round eyes. Just as she smiled and was about to greet Ling Dang, Ling Dang immediately covered her mouth, making a "shh" gesture, then pointed at Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu hadn't woken yet. She must have had some nightmare, her brows tightly furrowed.

Liang Shi continued lying there holding Ling Dang. It must be said, holding a soft little kid in her arms was like holding a small warming stove.

She took out two candies from the drawer and handed them to Ling Dang.

Sure enough, Ling Dang's eyes immediately lit up.

But she first unwrapped one and fed it to Liang Shi's mouth before eating one herself.

The blanket on Xu Qingzhu's side had also slipped down, exposing her beautiful, pale, slender shoulder. Liang Shi pressed her lips together lightly, reached out with her long arm to pull the blanket up for her. But Xu Qingzhu suddenly opened her eyes, those eyes full of wariness.

It startled Liang Shi.

Seeing it was Liang Shi, Xu Qingzhu finally let out a soft breath.

Ling Dang immediately moved closer, her soft little voice saying: "Auntie¹, did you have a nightmare?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded, her arm resting over her eyes, responding weakly: "Mm."

"It's okay, it's okay." Ling Dang lay beside her, moving close to her face and giving her a kiss. "A kiss and the nightmare goes away."

Xu Qingzhu, who had been frightened by the nightmare, smiled at these words and immediately pulled Ling Dang into her arms, kissing her soft little face. "How are you so good at talking? Did you put honey on your lips?"

"No." Ling Dang blinked. "Auntie² put honey on her lips."

Liang Shi: "Huh?"

Ling Dang said: "Auntie's lips are sweet. Auntie, you can try."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Liang Shi gave her a light tap. "What are you saying?"

Ling Dang let out a soft hum. "But it's true. You just ate candy, isn't it sweet?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu was amused by her "childish words" and wanted to laugh, but deliberately put on a stern face to tease her: "You two were sneaking candy again?"

Ling Dang pressed her lips together, staring with round eyes, and without hesitation betrayed Liang Shi: "Auntie gave it to me."

Facing Xu Qingzhu's oppressive gaze, Liang Shi swallowed, then pulled out another candy from the drawer and handed it over.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "I don't eat them."

Liang Shi: "....."

Then she called to Liang Shi: "Come here."

Liang Shi was stunned: "Huh?"

But her body was very honest and moved over. Xu Qingzhu held Ling Dang with one hand, and reached out with the other, her fingertip gently brushing the corner of Liang Shi's mouth.

Xu Qingzhu had just woken up, and her clear, cool voice carried a hint of hoarseness, sounding especially alluring. "Sneaking candy and not even wiping your mouth clean."

Liang Shi: "?"

Xu Qingzhu showed her fingertip—on it was a white candy crumb.

Liang Shi felt embarrassed.

But Xu Qingzhu let out a soft laugh, her voice lazy and casual: "Teacher Liang, how are you just like a little kid?"

Liang Shi: "....."

This was an accident!!!

Footnotes:

¹ Auntie (姑母): A formal term for paternal aunt (father's sister), which is how Ling Dang addresses Xu Qingzhu in this context.

² Auntie (姑姑): A less formal, more affectionate term for paternal aunt (father's sister), which is how Ling Dang addresses Liang Shi. The distinction in Chinese shows the different levels of closeness or formality, though both translate to "auntie" in English.